

FOIA Request Letter Template

Virginia, Maryland, DC & North Carolina — jurisdiction-specific templates with legal citations.

NOTE: For high-stakes requests, have an attorney review before sending.

Virginia FOIA (Va. Code § 2.2-3700 et seq.)

[YOUR NAME] [ADDRESS] [DATE] FOIA Officer, [AGENCY NAME], [AGENCY ADDRESS] RE: VIRGINIA FREEDOM OF INFORMATION ACT REQUEST Pursuant to Va. Code § 2.2-3700 et seq., I request the following public records: [DESCRIBE RECORDS — specific dates, officers, incident numbers, document types] Under Va. Code § 2.2-3704(B), you must respond within FIVE (5) WORKING DAYS. If any portion is denied, cite the specific statutory exemption per Va. Code § 2.2-3704(E). I request a fee waiver as disclosure serves the public interest. [NAME / SIGNATURE / CONTACT]

Maryland PIA (Md. Code, Gen. Prov. § 4-101 et seq.)

[YOUR NAME] [DATE] Custodian of Records, [AGENCY NAME] RE: MARYLAND PUBLIC INFORMATION ACT REQUEST Pursuant to Md. Code, Gen. Prov. §§ 4-101 et seq., I request: [DESCRIBE RECORDS] Respond within THIRTY (30) WORKING DAYS per § 4-203. Cite exemptions under § 4-305 or § 4-307 for any withheld records. [NAME / DATE]

Washington DC FOIA (D.C. Code § 2-531 et seq.)

[YOUR NAME] [DATE] D.C. Agency FOIA Officer, [AGENCY NAME] RE: DC FREEDOM OF INFORMATION ACT REQUEST Pursuant to D.C. Code §§ 2-531 through 2-540, I request: [DESCRIBE RECORDS] Respond within FIFTEEN (15) BUSINESS DAYS per § 2-532(c). Provide a Vaughn index for any withheld records per § 2-534. [NAME / DATE]

North Carolina Public Records (N.C.G.S. § 132-1 et seq.)

[YOUR NAME] [DATE] Records Custodian, [AGENCY NAME] RE: NORTH CAROLINA PUBLIC RECORDS REQUEST Under N.C.G.S. § 132-1 et seq., public records belong to the people. I request: [DESCRIBE RECORDS] NC law requires agencies to respond "as promptly as possible." I request response within TEN (10) BUSINESS DAYS. Cite exemptions under N.C.G.S. § 132-1.4 for any withheld records. [NAME / DATE]

Common Record Types — Suggested Language

Record Type	Suggested Request Language
Body Camera Footage	All body-worn camera footage from incident on [DATE] involving officer(s) [NAME/BADGE] at [LOCATION].
Use of Force Reports	All use-of-force reports, supplemental reports, and incident reports for [OFFICER/INCIDENT ID] from [DATE RANGE].
Complaint History	All civilian complaints, internal affairs records, and disciplinary records for officer [NAME/BADGE#] — last 5 years.
Department Policies	Current written policies, general orders governing use of force, body camera, and stop-and-frisk.

Record Type	Suggested Request Language
Budget Records	Departmental budget, expenditure reports, and grant records for fiscal year [YEAR].
<i>TIP: Track every request: date sent, agency, tracking number, deadline, response. Follow up by phone on day 4 if no confirmation.</i>	